

THE CURRICULUM • THE DEGREE

The *Four* Years

BA IN TECHNOLOGY • 120 UNITS • 8 SEMESTERS • CONCENTRATION DECLARED END OF YEAR 2

First a common language. Then your focus. Two years of shared Foundation — the books, the mathematics, the code, the Workshop — so every student can speak both art and engineering. Then four depth studios in the concentration you choose: Media, Design, or Engineering. And it doesn't start with a mountain: it starts with one ten-minute day.

YEARS 1–2

THE FOUNDATION

First, you learn both languages.

Every artist here trains in the engineer's tools, and every engineer in the artist's — these two years are identical for every student, no electives, on purpose. Each course is named for what it actually teaches; the formal catalog name rides along in small print for the transcript people.

The Ancient World — *Homer, Plato, and the tragedians, read beside The Endless Summer and The Matrix.*

HUM 101 • 2 UNITS

The Mathematics of Motion — *every drop-in, racing line, and fading swell, finally explained. Physical before formal, always.*

MATH 110 • CALCULUS I • 4 UNITS

How Things Move — *the ocean and the board; lab on the sand and in the water.*

PHYS 110 • MECHANICS • 4 UNITS

Speaking to Machines — *your first code, with AI tools open on the table from day one.*

CS 110 • PROGRAMMING FUNDAMENTALS • 4 UNITS

The Workshop — *your first project team, your first build.*

WKSP 101 • 2 UNITS

Rome to the Renaissance — *Aurelius beside Dogtown and Z-Boys; da Vinci's notebooks as the founding model.*

HUM 102 • 2 UNITS

The Mathematics of Sound — *harmonics and Fourier, discovered through synthesizers and the studio.*

MATH 120 • CALCULUS II • 4 UNITS

Why Waves Break — *swell, fin theory, why Black's works — ends with a board you shaped and can defend.*

PHYS 120 • WAVES, ENERGY & FLUIDS • 4 UNITS

How Machines Think — *from logic gates all the way up. No magic left anywhere in the stack.*

CS 120 • COMPUTATIONAL THINKING & SYSTEMS • 4 UNITS

How Music Moves — *recording, production, and how a song actually reaches the world.*

SIG 101 • 1 UNIT

The Workshop — *ships at the year-end public exhibition.*

WKSP 102 • 2 UNITS

→ YEAR ONE ENDS WITH YOUR WORK IN A PUBLIC EXHIBITION

The Enlightenment — *the arguments that built the modern world, argued live.*

HUM 201 • 2 UNITS

The Mathematics of Images — *every photograph, mix session, and AI model is the same math underneath — and it's yours now.*

MATH 210 • LINEAR ALGEBRA • 4 UNITS

Writing That Lands — *heavy output, line-edited. Clarity is a trained skill.*

RHET 110 • WRITING SEMINAR • 4 UNITS

Making Things Fast — *why some programs fly and others crawl — and how to prove it.*

CS 210 • DATA STRUCTURES & ALGORITHMS • 4 UNITS

The Workshop — *real clients begin.*

WKSP 201 • 2 UNITS

The Industrial Mind — *Frankenstein beside Blade Runner and the birth of electronic music.*

HUM 202 • 2 UNITS

Forecasting & Games — *swell models, prediction markets, poker — the mathematics of not being sure.*

MATH 220 • PROBABILITY & STATISTICS • 4 UNITS

Teaching Machines — *what a model is, how it learns, what it cannot know.*

CS 220 • MACHINE LEARNING I • 4 UNITS

Knowing What's True — *bias, propaganda, information warfare — self-defense for your mind.*

RHET 210 • EPISTEMIC SELF-DEFENSE • 4 UNITS

How Images Move — *cinema, short-form, and the economics of attention.*

SIG 201 • 1 UNIT

The Workshop

WKSP 202 • 2 UNITS

→ THE DECLARATION: YOU CHOOSE YOUR CONCENTRATION — MEDIA, DESIGN, OR ENGINEERING

Then you sharpen — and ship.

Four depth studios in your concentration, a full term inside a real studio, lab, or venture, the Crossing — one depth studio from outside your concentration, required, because that's the point — and a final work defended in public. The shared spine continues throughout: the Canon, Culture & Signal, the Workshop.

SEMESTER 5

The Age of Intelligence — *Turing and cybernetics beside the science fiction that saw it coming.*

HUM 301 • 2 UNITS

Depth Studio I — *your concentration's first studio (see below).*

4 UNITS

Depth Studio II

4 UNITS

How Scenes Form — *punk, hip-hop, skate, surf — small rooms that invented what everyone uses later.*

SIG 301 • 1 UNIT

The Workshop

WKSP 301 • 2 UNITS

SEMESTER 6

LIGHTER LOAD, ON PURPOSE

The Field Term — *a full term embedded in a working studio, lab, agency, or venture, under a mentor, doing real work.*

FLD 301 • 4 UNITS

Ethics & Statecraft — *what you make changes who has power; here's what that asks of you.*

HUM 302 • 2 UNITS

Depth Studio III

4 UNITS

The Workshop

WKSP 302 • 2 UNITS

SEMESTER 7

The California Canon — *Steinbeck, Didion, and surf cinema — the place itself, read as a text.*

HUM 401 • 2 UNITS

Working with Intelligence — *the studied craft of directing AI: delegation, verification, taste.*

CS 320 • HUMAN-AI COLLABORATION • 4 UNITS

Depth Studio IV

4 UNITS

The Capstone begins — *your final work: proposed, scoped, and underway.*

CAP 401 • 2 UNITS

The Workshop — *you lead first-years now.*

WKSP 401 • 2 UNITS

SEMESTER 8

The Long View — *your capstone, argued against everything you've read in four years.*

HUM 402 • 2 UNITS

The Crossing — *one depth studio from outside your concentration, your choice — required.*

4 UNITS

Open Studio — *from the rotating slate: visiting masters, deep cuts, a second crossing.*

4 UNITS

How to Build a Signal — *you ship a real cultural artifact to a real audience.*

SIG 401 • 1 UNIT

The Capstone, defended — *in public, before faculty and outside examiners.*

CAP 402 • 2 UNITS

The Workshop — *final exhibition.*

WKSP 402 • 2 UNITS

→ CAPSTONE DEFENSE • YOU TEACH A FIRST-YEAR • GRADUATION

THE CONCENTRATIONS

DECLARED YEAR 2

Eight studios. Your four.

The depth catalog is eight studios; each concentration prescribes four of them. The lists overlap on purpose — Design shares studios with both neighbors, because design is where made things meet people. The Crossing sends you outside your four, once, required.

MEDIA — THINGS PEOPLE WATCH, HEAR, AND FEEL

Film & the Moving Image — *camera, edit, story. You ship a short film.*

ART 320 · 4 UNITS

Music Production & Sound Design — *the studio as instrument.*

ART 330 · 4 UNITS

Interactive Media & Interfaces — *games, installations, the designed experience.*

ART 310 · 4 UNITS

Generative Media & Creative Code — *procedure and machine intelligence as artistic material.*

ART 410 · 4 UNITS

DESIGN — THINGS PEOPLE USE

Interactive Media & Interfaces — *the designed experience, watched in the hands of real users.*

ART 310 · 4 UNITS

Generative Media & Creative Code — *systems that design alongside you.*

ART 410 · 4 UNITS

Mechanical Design & Fabrication — *CAD to shop floor; tolerance is a moral category.*

ENGR 310 · 4 UNITS

Embedded Systems & Sensors — *physical computing; objects that sense and respond.*

ENGR 320 · 4 UNITS

ENGINEERING — THINGS THAT WORK ON THEIR OWN

Machine Learning II / AI Systems — *deployment, evaluation, agents, failure modes.*

CS 310 · 4 UNITS

Mechanical Design & Fabrication — *CAD to shop floor.*

ENGR 310 · 4 UNITS

Embedded Systems & Sensors — *firmware, ocean sensors, instruments that survive saltwater.*

ENGR 320 · 4 UNITS

Robotics & Autonomous Systems — *perception, control, autonomy in the physical world.*

ENGR 410 · 4 UNITS

WHAT YOU WALK OUT WITH

A defended original work that exists outside any classroom — a finished film, a released record, a product with real users, a system that runs, a venture that exists — plus four years of exhibited Workshop builds and a portfolio that is the actual credential. *The credential is the interface; the portfolio is the truth.*

NEXT

STATUS

Open curriculum, working framework. SDIT is not yet authorized to grant degrees — see [Accreditation](#) for exactly where that stands. Formal catalog names for every course are listed in [the catalog](#).